

Count Fast and Slow Losers				
				Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers			
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

A collection of playing cards. On the left is a 10 of Clubs. Next to it is a King of Diamonds. To the right is an Ace of Spades. Further right is a Queen of Hearts. In the foreground, a fan of cards is spread out, showing the Ace of Clubs, 2 of Clubs, 3 of Clubs, 4 of Clubs, 5 of Clubs, 6 of Clubs, 7 of Clubs, 8 of Clubs, 9 of Clubs, 10 of Clubs, Jack of Clubs, Queen of Clubs, King of Clubs, Ace of Diamonds, 2 of Diamonds, 3 of Diamonds, 4 of Diamonds, 5 of Diamonds, 6 of Diamonds, 7 of Diamonds, 8 of Diamonds, 9 of Diamonds, 10 of Diamonds, Jack of Diamonds, Queen of Diamonds, King of Diamonds, Ace of Hearts, 2 of Hearts, 3 of Hearts, 4 of Hearts, 5 of Hearts, 6 of Hearts, 7 of Hearts, 8 of Hearts, and 9 of Hearts.

Count Sure Winners				
				Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♣

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

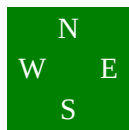
♠ A 9 8 2
 ♥ 10 6 3
 ♦ J 10 9 4
 ♣ 5 4

♠ K Q 6 5

♥ A K 9 7

♦ 8

♣ A Q J 2



♠ 10 7 3

♥ 8 5 2

♦ K 7 6 3 2

♣ 9 6

♠ J 4

♥ Q J 4

♦ A Q 5

♣ K 10 8 7 3

West

North

East

South

1♣

Pass

3♣

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♣

All Pass

6♣ by North

a slam. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers with 5♦. What say you?

You dealt this hand.

Nice hand! But not strong enough to open with anything other than 1♣. Partner jumps to 3♣!

You might be tempted to mention one of your Majors at this point, but resist the temptation. Trust that your partner also knows the bidding priorities and that he would have bid a 4-card Major if he had held one. The problem with you now saying 3♥ for example, is that partner would probably think you had a 5-card ♥ suit and support you with only 3 of them. You know that ♣s is your suit so stick to it.

With partner showing 13-16 points, and your hand revaluing to 21 you are definitely thinking slam. It would not be terrible to just bid 6♣ right now, but Blackwood was invented just for these situations, to make sure you are not missing 2 Aces when you bid

Blackwood did its job. You are missing one Ace so all thoughts of a Grand are put aside. Bid 6♣.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J
 ♥ Q 7 3
 ♦ K Q 10 6 2
 ♣ 10 9 2

♠ K 8 4 3 2

♥ 8 5

♦ 9 5 4

♣ K J 8



♠ Q 10 5
 ♥ A J 9
 ♦ J 8 7 3
 ♣ A Q 5

♠ 9 7 6

♥ K 10 6 4 2

♦ A

♣ 7 6 4 3

*West**North**East**South*

3♦

Pass

1♦

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

You dealt this hand.

This would be a perfect hand to open 1NT - well, it would be if it held one more point. But with only 14 you open your 4-card Minor, 1♦. Partner responds 3♦.

Partner suggests that ♦s is your suit, and he may be right. But you would much rather play the less demanding Notrump game if he is willing. So you bid 3NT, knowing that if partner is really distributional he will take you back to ♦s. He doesn't, so you play 3NT.